

Lesson 12: Hearing It Happen

GDevelop

VIDEO GAME CREATION

This week: your game finally sounds like a game. Four moments - firing, hitting, clearing a wave, and losing - each get their own distinct cue.

Open your own [YourName]Game project from Lesson 11 - don't start a new one.

If you already built an optional sound idea in an earlier lesson (Lessons 2, 3, 4, or 6), keep it - today reuses it directly instead of replacing it. If you didn't, today's steps are written as if starting fresh.

Setup

1. Open your [YourName]Game project from Lesson 11.
2. No new resource-import step needed - GDevelop's "Play a sound" action references .wav files directly, the same as Lesson 3.

Level 1 - Minimal (MVP)

Four sounds fire at the correct moment, at least once each: a shot, a hit/explosion, a wave-clear (on any non-final wave), and a game over. No silence, no obviously wrong triggers.

3. Confirm the shoot event already has "Action: Play a sound (sfx_shoot.wav)" (Lesson 3) - add it now if it's missing.
4. On the bullet-enemy collision event, add "Action: Play a sound (sfx_hit.wav)" alongside the existing Score/EnemiesRemaining actions.
5. On the full-win event (Wave >= TotalWaves, from Lesson 11), add "Action: Play a sound (sfx_win.wav)".
6. On the advance-wave event (Wave < TotalWaves, from Lesson 11), add "Action: Play a sound (sfx_wave.wav)".
7. On the lose event (Lives <= 0, from Lesson 8/10), add "Action: Play a sound (sfx_lose.wav)".
8. Click Preview and play through a full round - shoot, hit, an early wave clear, and a loss should each sound distinct.

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Bullet-Enemy collision event (revised):
Condition: Bullet is in collision with Enemy
Action: Score = Score + 10
Action: EnemiesRemaining = EnemiesRemaining - 1
Action: Play a sound (sfx_hit.wav)
Action: Delete Bullet
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Action: Delete Enemy

Full-win event (revised):
Condition: EnemiesRemaining <= 0
Condition: Wave >= TotalWaves
Action: GameActive = 0
Action: Show WinText
Action: Play a sound (sfx_win.wav)

Advance-wave event (revised):
Condition: EnemiesRemaining <= 0
Condition: Wave < TotalWaves
Action: Wave = Wave + 1
Action: EnemiesRemaining = 5
Action: Play a sound (sfx_wave.wav)
Action: Repeat 5 times -> Create Enemy

Lose event (revised):
Condition: Lives <= 0
Action: GameActive = 0
Action: Show LoseText
Action: Play a sound (sfx_lose.wav)
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Level 2 - Complete (Alpha/Beta)

All four sounds fire reliably every time, with no missing or duplicate playback, and each is clearly distinguishable from the others by ear.

- Play a full round: shoot, hit, an early wave clear, and a loss each produce a distinct sound.
- If you built the optional win sound, confirm it still plays on the true win, and sfx_wave.wav doesn't also fire on that same frame - the full-win and advance-wave events' Wave conditions should keep them mutually exclusive.
- "Play a sound" fires once per action - confirm rapid shooting and a hit landing together both play correctly, with no sound cutting another off.

Level 3 - Refined (Ready to Publish) - pick any that interest you

- Audio: if you haven't already, add the optional win sound now - it slots into the exact same "Play a sound" action as today's wave/lose sounds, just a different event.
- Audio: add a Random object action to pick between two hit sound files each time, so repeated hits don't sound completely identical.
- Structure: for extra practice, try moving the repeated Play-a-sound actions into a Function (Project > Functions) that takes a filename parameter, callable from every event that needs one - not required, but a natural extension of Lesson 11's optional Functions idea.

If Something's Wrong

- No sound on wave-clear: confirm the advance-wave event's Play-a-sound action is present and its Wave < TotalWaves condition is correct.
- Both win and wave-clear sounds play together: confirm the two events' Wave conditions are exact opposites (>= vs. <), matching Lesson 11's original troubleshooting note.

- Lose sound plays repeatedly: confirm the lose event's Lives <= 0 condition is a one-time trigger tied to GameActive, matching Lesson 8/10's pattern.

Want More?

Student Resource List > GDevelop section, or wiki.gdevelop.io